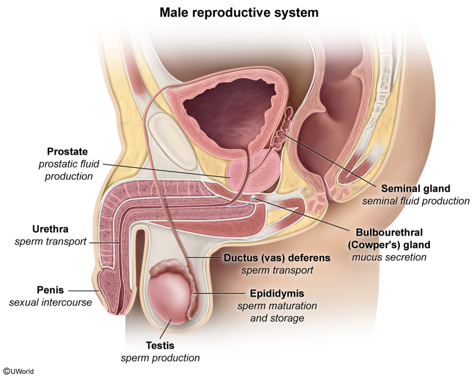
One function of the bulbourethral glands is to:

- ✔ A. secrete a mucus that is thick and alkaline. [59%]
- B. facilitate sperm maturation. [4%]
- C. transfer mature sperm to the urethra. [9%]
- D. produce the largest portion of seminal fluid. [26%]

Correct
60% answered correctly

Explanation:



The male reproductive system is responsible for producing sperm (ie, gametes) and includes the following structures:

- Testes: reproductive glands that produce sperm during spermatogenesis.
- Epididymis: a long, tightly coiled tube on the posterior of each testis; immobile sperm produced by the testes become mature and motile within this tube. Mature sperm are stored in the epididymis until release **(Choice B)**.
- Ductus (vas) deferens: a long, muscular tube that transfers mature sperm to the urethra **(Choice C)**.
- Seminal glands: accessory glands that produce the largest portion of seminal fluid **(Choice D)**.
- Prostate: a gland that produces prostatic fluid containing enzymes necessary to prevent the coagulation of sperm in the vagina.
- **Bulbourethral (Cowper's) glands**: glands that secrete **thick, alkaline mucus** to lubricate the tip of the penis. The alkalinity of the mucus neutralizes acids in the urine to protect the sperm from the acidic environment of the urethra.
- Penis: an exterior organ that functions in sexual intercourse by which ejaculation of semen (mixture of sperm and seminal fluid) occurs.

Educational objective:
As part of the male reproductive system, the bulbourethral glands secrete a thick, alkaline mucus to lubricate the tip of the penis. This alkaline mucus neutralizes acids in the urine to protect the sperm from the acidic environment of the urethra.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
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System:
Reproduction

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